

The Contemporary World

Complete Study Guide · AY 2026-2027

INTRODUCTION

00 Course Overview

FOUNDATIONS

01 Understanding Globalization

02 History of Globalization

SYSTEMS

03 The Global Economy

04 Global Governance

05 Demography & Mobility

CULTURE & ISSUES

06 Global Culture & Media

07 Environment & Sustainability

08 Inequality, Citizenship & PH

The Contemporary World

SOCSCI 3 — Complete Study Reference

Course: **SOCSCI 3**

Units: **3 units**

CHED Mandate: **GE Core Course**

Type: **Global Studies**

CHAPTER 00

Course Overview

The Contemporary World is one of the CHED-mandated General Education courses required across ALL Philippine college programs, regardless of major. It examines **globalization** — the accelerating interconnection of the world's economies, governments, cultures, and

The Contemporary World

Complete Study Guide · AY 2026-2027

INTRODUCTION

00 Course Overview

FOUNDATIONS

01 Understanding Globalization

02 History of Globalization

SYSTEMS

03 The Global Economy

04 Global Governance

05 Demography & Mobility

CULTURE & ISSUES

06 Global Culture & Media

07 Environment & Sustainability

08 Inequality, Citizenship & PH

peoples — and asks what that interconnection means for ordinary people, nations, and the Philippines specifically. Unlike RIZAL (one person's biography) or CC 101 (fixed technical facts), this course studies systems that are actively shifting RIGHT NOW — meaning some content here reflects the world as of mid-2026, not settled history.

Why "Contemporary" Actually Matters Here

This is not a history course. When your professor asks about "the current state of globalization," they want you to reference genuinely recent developments — trade tensions, shifting alliances, new technology — not decade-old textbook examples. This guide includes several 2025-2026 developments specifically because currency is part of the actual subject matter.

Exam & Discussion Priority Map

Topic	Chapter	Weight	Format Usually Tested
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The Contemporary World

Complete Study Guide · AY 2026-2027

INTRODUCTION

00 Course Overview

FOUNDATIONS

01 Understanding Globalization

02 History of Globalization

SYSTEMS

03 The Global Economy

04 Global Governance

05 Demography & Mobility

CULTURE & ISSUES

06 Global Culture & Media

07 Environment & Sustainability

08 Inequality, Citizenship & PH

Topic	Chapter	Weight	Format Usually Tested
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Globalization definitions & theories		Very High	Identification essay, theory application
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Global economy (IMF/WB/WTO, trade)	03	High	Identification case analysis
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Global governance & the UN system	04	High	Identification structure diagrams
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Migration, OFWs & global mobility	05	Medium-High	Case study, Philippine-specific essay
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SDGs & environmental governance	07	Medium	Identification position paper
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Cultural globalization & glocalization	06	Medium	Reflection essay, examples
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Global inequality & citizenship	08	Medium	Reflection, synthesis essay
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History/waves of globalization	02	Lower	Timeline, identification
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INTRODUCTION

- 00 Course Overview

FOUNDATIONS

- 01 Understanding Globalization
- 02 History of Globalization

SYSTEMS

- 03 The Global Economy
- 04 Global Governance
- 05 Demography & Mobility

CULTURE & ISSUES

- 06 Global Culture & Media
- 07 Environment & Sustainability
- 08 Inequality, Citizenship & PH

Understanding Globalization

Before analyzing globalization's effects, you need a precise working definition and a map of its different dimensions — economists, political scientists, and cultural theorists don't all mean the same thing when they say "globalization."

Working Definition

Globalization is the ongoing process by which economies, societies, cultures, and populations become increasingly interconnected and interdependent through the accelerated flow of trade, capital, people, information, and ideas across national borders. It is NOT a single event with a start date — it is an intensifying, uneven, and contested PROCESS, still actively unfolding and even reversing in some areas today.

The Contemporary World

Complete Study Guide · AY 2026-2027

INTRODUCTION

00 Course Overview

FOUNDATIONS

01 Understanding Globalization

02 History of Globalization

SYSTEMS

03 The Global Economy

04 Global Governance

05 Demography & Mobility

CULTURE & ISSUES

06 Global Culture & Media

07 Environment & Sustainability

08 Inequality, Citizenship & PH

The Five Dimensions of Globalization

Economic

Global trade, finance, multinational corporations, supply chains

Political

International organizations, treaties, shared governance, sovereignty tension

Cultural

Shared media values, lifestyles spreading across borders

Technological

Internet, mobile networks, AI — the infrastructure enabling all other dimensions

Ecological

Climate change, pollution, and resource use as borderless, shared problems

The Contemporary World

Complete Study Guide · AY 2026-2027

INTRODUCTION

00 Course Overview

FOUNDATIONS

01 Understanding Globalization

02 History of Globalization

SYSTEMS

03 The Global Economy

04 Global Governance

05 Demography & Mobility

CULTURE & ISSUES

06 Global Culture & Media

07 Environment & Sustainability

08 Inequality, Citizenship & PH

Filipino Example Touching All Five Dimensions

A single Filipino nurse working in the UK sending money home via GCash touches all five at once: **economic** (remittance flow), **political** (bilateral labor agreements between PH and UK), **cultural** (Filipino traditions carried abroad, British culture absorbed), **technological** (instant digital money transfer), and **ecological** (the carbon footprint of international travel itself). This is the kind of multi-dimensional example professors want you to construct on essay exams.

Three Major Theoretical Perspectives on Globalization

Scholars disagree sharply on how significant, new, and beneficial globalization actually is. Three broad camps dominate the academic debate — expect exam questions asking you to identify or apply one of these.

The Contemporary World

Complete Study Guide · AY 2026-2027

INTRODUCTION

00 Course Overview

FOUNDATIONS

01 Understanding Globalization

02 History of Globalization

SYSTEMS

03 The Global Economy

04 Global Governance

05 Demography & Mobility

CULTURE & ISSUES

06 Global Culture & Media

07 Environment & Sustainability

08 Inequality, Citizenship & PH

Perspective

Core Claim

Key Idea

Hyperglobalist

Globalization is real, new, and transformative — the nation-state is becoming less relevant as global markets and institutions take over

Borders are dissolving; we live in a genuinely "borderless world" economically

Skeptic

Globalization is exaggerated — international trade levels today aren't fundamentally different from earlier historical peaks (e.g. pre-WWI trade), and nation-states remain the dominant actors

What we call "globalization" is mostly regionalization between blocs (EU, ASEAN, NAFTA/USMCA), not true global integration

Transformationalist

Globalization is real and significant, but its outcomes are unpredictable, uneven, and actively reshape (not

The most widely accepted "middle ground" view among contemporar scholars — globalization

The Contemporary World
Complete Study Guide · AY 2026-2027

INTRODUCTION

00 Course Overview

FOUNDATIONS

01 Understanding Globalization

02 History of Globalization

SYSTEMS

03 The Global Economy

04 Global Governance

05 Demography & Mobility

CULTURE & ISSUES

06 Global Culture & Media

07 Environment & Sustainability

08 Inequality, Citizenship & PH

Perspective	Core Claim	Key Idea
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	eliminate) state power	changes HO states gover not WHETHER they govern
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Exam-Critical Fact —
2026 Events Actually
Support the Skeptic View

The United States formally withdrawing from over 60 international organizations in January 2026 and rejecting the UN's Sustainable Development Goals is a textbook example Skeptics would point to: even the world's most powerful economy can simply choose to disengage from global institutions when it suits national interest — evidence that state sovereignty, not borderless global governance, still drives outcomes. This is a genuinely current, citable example for essay questions on this theory.

Key Theorists to Know

Thomas Friedman Journalist, b. 1953 "The World Is Flat" (2005)	Arjun Appadurai Anthropologist, b. 1949 Five Global "Scapes"	Roland Robertson Sociologist, b. 1938 Coined "Glocalization"
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The Contemporary World

Complete Study Guide · AY 2026-2027

INTRODUCTION

00 Course Overview

FOUNDATIONS

01 Understanding Globalization

02 History of Globalization

SYSTEMS

03 The Global Economy

04 Global Governance

05 Demography & Mobility

CULTURE & ISSUES

06 Global Culture & Media

07 Environment & Sustainability

08 Inequality, Citizenship & PH

Popularized the hyperglobalist idea that technology has "flattened" competitive playing fields globally, allowing individuals and small firms anywhere to compete internationally.

Proposed globalization flows through 5 dimensions: ethnoscap (people), mediascapes (images/info), technoscapes (technology), financescapes (capital), and ideoscapes (ideologies).

Argued global and local forces don't simply replace each other — they blend, producing hybrid outcomes adapted to local contexts. Central to Chapter 06.

CHAPTER 02

History & Waves of Globalization

Globalization is not a 21st-century invention — trade networks, migration, and cultural exchange span thousands of years. Historians typically describe globalization as occurring in distinct "waves," each accelerated by a specific technological or political shift.

The Contemporary World

Complete Study Guide · AY 2026-2027

INTRODUCTION

00 Course Overview

FOUNDATIONS

01 Understanding Globalization

02 History of Globalization

SYSTEMS

03 The Global Economy

04 Global Governance

05 Demography & Mobility

CULTURE & ISSUES

06 Global Culture & Media

07 Environment & Sustainability

08 Inequality, Citizenship & PH

Timeline — The Major Waves of Globalization

~130 BC

The Silk Road Opens

Trade routes connecting China, Central Asia, the Middle East, and Europe. Carried silk, spices, and technology — but also ideas, religions, and disease, across thousands of kilometers, over centuries.

The Contemporary World

Complete Study Guide · AY 2026-2027

INTRODUCTION

00 Course Overview

FOUNDATIONS

01 Understanding Globalization

02 History of Globalization

SYSTEMS

03 The Global Economy

04 Global Governance

05 Demography & Mobility

CULTURE & ISSUES

06 Global Culture & Media

07 Environment & Sustainability

08 Inequality, Citizenship & PH

1400s-1600s



Wave 1 —
The Age of
Exploration

European maritime powers (Spain, Portugal, later Netherlands, England) connected the Americas, Africa, Asia, and Europe into a single trading system for the first time. This is also the era that led directly to Spanish colonization of the Philippines (1521 onward) — globalization and colonialism were deeply intertwined from this point forward.

The Contemporary World

Complete Study Guide · AY 2026-2027

INTRODUCTION

- 00 Course Overview

FOUNDATIONS

- 01 Understanding Globalization
- 02 History of Globalization

SYSTEMS

- 03 The Global Economy
- 04 Global Governance
- 05 Demography & Mobility

CULTURE & ISSUES

- 06 Global Culture & Media
- 07 Environment & Sustainability
- 08 Inequality, Citizenship & PH

1800s–1914

Wave 2 — Industrial-Era Globalization

Steamships, railroads, and the telegraph dramatically cut travel and communication time. Global trade volumes reached levels (relative to GDP) that some economists argue weren't matched again until the late 20th century — a key data point Skeptic theorists cite.

1914–1945

The Great Reversal

Two World Wars and the Great Depression caused a dramatic RETREAT from global trade and integration — proof that globalization is not automatically permanent or one-directional. Countries turned inward (protectionism, tariffs) during this period.

The Contemporary World

Complete Study Guide · AY 2026-2027

INTRODUCTION

00 Course Overview

FOUNDATIONS

01 Understanding Globalization

02 History of Globalization

SYSTEMS

03 The Global Economy

04 Global Governance

05 Demography & Mobility

CULTURE & ISSUES

06 Global Culture & Media

07 Environment & Sustainability

08 Inequality, Citizenship & PH

1944–1947

Post-War Institution Building

The Bretton Woods Conference (1944) created the IMF and World Bank. The GATT (General Agreement on Tariffs and Trade, precursor to the WTO) was signed in 1947 — deliberately designed to prevent a repeat of the 1930s trade collapse. Covered fully in Chapter 03.

1989–1991

Wave 3 — Post- Cold War Acceleration

Fall of the Berlin Wall (1989) and Soviet collapse (1991) opened former communist economies to global markets. Widely seen as the beginning of the most intense phase of globalization to date.

The Contemporary World

Complete Study Guide · AY 2026-2027

INTRODUCTION

00 Course Overview

FOUNDATIONS

01 Understanding Globalization

02 History of Globalization

SYSTEMS

03 The Global Economy

04 Global Governance

05 Demography & Mobility

CULTURE & ISSUES

06 Global Culture & Media

07 Environment & Sustainability

08 Inequality, Citizenship & PH

1995

World Trade Organization founded

Replaced GATT with a permanent, more powerful institution to govern global trade rules and resolve disputes between nations. Covered in Chapter 03.

2001–2010s

Wave 4 — The Digital & Internet Wave

China joins WTO (2001), smartphones and broadband internet spread globally, social media connects billions instantly. Information and culture now move at near-zero marginal cost across borders.

The Contemporary World

Complete Study Guide · AY 2026-2027

INTRODUCTION

00 Course Overview

FOUNDATIONS

01 Understanding Globalization

02 History of Globalization

SYSTEMS

03 The Global Economy

04 Global Governance

05 Demography & Mobility

CULTURE & ISSUES

06 Global Culture & Media

07 Environment & Sustainability

08 Inequality, Citizenship & PH

2020-2023



COVID-19

Disruption

Global supply chains broke down simultaneously worldwide, border closures halted international travel and migration, exposing how fragile deep global interdependence actually is. Many countries began actively "reshoring" critical manufacturing afterward.

The Contemporary World

Complete Study Guide · AY 2026-2027

INTRODUCTION

00 Course Overview

FOUNDATIONS

01 Understanding Globalization

02 History of Globalization

SYSTEMS

03 The Global Economy

04 Global Governance

05 Demography & Mobility

CULTURE & ISSUES

06 Global Culture & Media

07 Environment & Sustainability

08 Inequality, Citizenship & PH

2025-2026 •

Wave 5? —
Rising
Deglobalization
Pressures

Renewed tariff disputes, the US withdrawing from dozens of international bodies and rejecting the SDGs (Jan 2026), and new taxes on cross-border remittances (including a 1% US tax on OFW money transfers) signal a possible partial retreat from deep global integration — actively debated by scholars as this guide is being written.

The Contemporary World

Complete Study Guide · AY 2026-2027

INTRODUCTION

00 Course Overview

FOUNDATIONS

01 Understanding Globalization

02 History of Globalization

SYSTEMS

03 The Global Economy

04 Global Governance

05 Demography & Mobility

CULTURE & ISSUES

06 Global Culture & Media

07 Environment & Sustainability

08 Inequality, Citizenship & PH

Common Essay Prompt on This Chapter

"Is globalization inevitable, or can it reverse?" The 1914-1945 retreat AND the 2020s deglobalization pressures are your strongest historical evidence that globalization is NOT a one-way, unstoppable process — it has reversed before and shows signs of partial reversal again now. This directly supports Skeptic and Transformationalist positions over the Hyperglobalist view from Chapter 01.

CHAPTER 03

The Global Economy

This chapter covers the institutions and mechanisms that structure how money, goods, and services move across borders — the "hardware" of economic globalization.

The Contemporary World

Complete Study Guide · AY 2026-2027

INTRODUCTION

00 Course Overview

FOUNDATIONS

01 Understanding Globalization

02 History of Globalization

SYSTEMS

03 The Global Economy

04 Global Governance

05 Demography & Mobility

CULTURE & ISSUES

06 Global Culture & Media

07 Environment & Sustainability

08 Inequality, Citizenship & PH

The Big Three Post-War Institutions

IMF

Founded 1944,
Bretton Woods

International Monetary Fund

Monitors global financial stability, provides emergency loans to countries facing balance-of-payments crises, usually attached to policy conditions ("structural adjustment") the borrowing country must follow.

World Bank

Founded 1944,
Bretton Woods

International Bank for Reconstruction & Development

Provides long-term loans and grants for development projects (infrastructure, education, health) in developing countries, distinct from the IMF's short-term crisis focus.

WTO

Founded 1995,
Geneva

World Trade Organization

Sets global trade rules, negotiates trade agreements between member states, and provides a formal system for resolving trade disputes between countries.

The Contemporary World

Complete Study Guide · AY 2026-2027

INTRODUCTION

00 Course Overview

FOUNDATIONS

01 Understanding Globalization

02 History of Globalization

SYSTEMS

03 The Global Economy

04 Global Governance

05 Demography & Mobility

CULTURE & ISSUES

06 Global Culture & Media

07 Environment & Sustainability

08 Inequality, Citizenship & PH

Common Point of Confusion — IMF vs World Bank

Students frequently mix these up. Simple distinction: the **IMF** is like an emergency room — short-term crisis loans to stabilize a country's finances. The **World Bank** is like a long-term investor — development loans for building things (roads, schools, power grids) over years or decades.

Multinational Corporations (MNCs)

Companies that operate production, sales, or services across multiple countries simultaneously — among the most powerful economic actors in globalization, sometimes with revenues exceeding the GDP of entire nations.

Argument FOR MNCs

Create jobs and transfer technology/skills to host countries

Argument AGAINST MNCs

Can exploit weaker labor and environmental regulations in developing countries

The Contemporary World

Complete Study Guide · AY 2026-2027

INTRODUCTION

00 Course Overview

FOUNDATIONS

01 Understanding Globalization

02 History of Globalization

SYSTEMS

03 The Global Economy

04 Global Governance

05 Demography & Mobility

CULTURE & ISSUES

06 Global Culture & Media

07 Environment & Sustainability

08 Inequality, Citizenship & PH

Argument
FOR MNCs

Increase host-country tax revenue and infrastructure investment

Argument
AGAINST MNCs

Profits often flow back to the home country rather than staying local

Introduce competition, potentially lowering consumer prices

Can undercut and destroy local small businesses unable to compete

Connect local economies to global supply chains and markets

Can create dependency, leaving host economies vulnerable to the MNC's decisions

Global Supply Chains

A modern product is rarely made in one country. A single smartphone might have chip design in the US, semiconductor fabrication in Taiwan, rare-earth mineral mining in the DRC, assembly in China or Vietnam, and final sale worldwide — each step adding value in a different country before the final product reaches a consumer.

The Contemporary World

Complete Study Guide · AY 2026-2027

INTRODUCTION

00 Course Overview

FOUNDATIONS

01 Understanding Globalization

02 History of Globalization

SYSTEMS

03 The Global Economy

04 Global Governance

05 Demography & Mobility

CULTURE & ISSUES

06 Global Culture & Media

07 Environment & Sustainability

08 Inequality, Citizenship & PH

Philippine Example — BPO Industry

The Philippine Business Process Outsourcing (BPO) industry — call centers, back-office processing, IT services — is a direct product of global supply chains extending into SERVICES, not just physical goods. A US company can have its customer service handled entirely from a Manila call center, made possible by internet infrastructure, English proficiency, and labor cost differences — pure economic globalization in action, employing over a million Filipinos.

Free Trade vs Protectionism

Approach	Core Idea	Tools Used
Free Trade	Minimal government interference in cross-border trade; let comparative advantage determine what each country produces	Trade agreements (FTAs), tariff reduction, open borders for goods/ capital

The Contemporary World
Complete Study Guide · AY 2026-2027

INTRODUCTION

00 Course Overview

FOUNDATIONS

01 Understanding Globalization

02 History of Globalization

SYSTEMS

03 The Global Economy

04 Global Governance

05 Demography & Mobility

CULTURE & ISSUES

06 Global Culture & Media

07 Environment & Sustainability

08 Inequality, Citizenship & PH

Approach	Core Idea	Tools Used
Protectionism	Shield domestic industries from foreign competition to protect local jobs and strategic sectors	Tariffs (import taxes), import quotas, subsidies for domestic producers

Current 2025-2026
Example — Rising
Protectionism

Renewed tariff disputes between major economies through 2025-2026, alongside the new 1% US tax specifically targeting outbound remittances (directly affecting OFW families back home), are live examples of protectionist tools being actively deployed right now — useful, citable evidence for any essay asking you to identify CURRENT protectionist trends rather than historical ones.

Regional Trade Blocs

Bloc	Region	Purpose
ASEAN	Southeast Asia (10 members)	Regional economic and political cooperation;

The Contemporary World

Complete Study Guide · AY 2026-2027

INTRODUCTION

00 Course Overview

FOUNDATIONS

01 Understanding Globalization

02 History of Globalization

SYSTEMS

03 The Global Economy

04 Global Governance

05 Demography & Mobility

CULTURE & ISSUES

06 Global Culture & Media

07 Environment & Sustainability

08 Inequality, Citizenship & PH

Bloc	Region	Purpose
	incl. Philippines)	ASEAN Economic Community aims for freer movement of goods, services, and skilled labor within the region
EU	Europe (27 members)	Deepest regional integration globally — shared currency (Euro) for most members, common market, free movement of people
USMCA	North America (US, Mexico, Canada)	Successor to NAFTA, governs North American trade relations

The Contemporary World

Complete Study Guide · AY 2026-2027

INTRODUCTION

00 Course Overview

FOUNDATIONS

01 Understanding Globalization

02 History of Globalization

SYSTEMS

03 The Global Economy

04 Global Governance

05 Demography & Mobility

CULTURE & ISSUES

06 Global Culture & Media

07 Environment & Sustainability

08 Inequality, Citizenship & PH

Connects to Chapter 01 — The Skeptic Argument

Regional blocs like ASEAN and the EU are exactly what Skeptic theorists point to as evidence that "globalization" is often really just REGIONALIZATION — deeper integration within a bloc of neighboring countries, rather than true borderless global integration.

CHAPTER 04

Global Governance

If there's no single "world government," how does the international community coordinate on shared problems at all? This chapter covers the institutions, and the fundamental tension, at the heart of global governance: no country wants to give up its sovereignty, yet many problems (pandemics, climate change, trade) cannot be solved by any single country alone.

The Contemporary World

Complete Study Guide · AY 2026–2027

INTRODUCTION

00 Course Overview

FOUNDATIONS

01 Understanding Globalization

02 History of Globalization

SYSTEMS

03 The Global Economy

04 Global Governance

05 Demography & Mobility

CULTURE & ISSUES

06 Global Culture & Media

07 Environment & Sustainability

08 Inequality, Citizenship & PH

What Is Global Governance?

Global governance refers to the collective ways states, international organizations, and other actors cooperate to manage shared global problems — WITHOUT a central world government holding binding authority over sovereign nations. It relies on treaties, voluntary cooperation, shared norms, and institutions that countries choose to join and can, in principle, choose to leave.

The United Nations System

193

UN Member States (nearly every country on Earth)

1945

Founded, after WWII, headquartered in New York

6

Official UN languages

The Contemporary World

Complete Study Guide · AY 2026-2027

INTRODUCTION

00 Course Overview

FOUNDATIONS

01 Understanding Globalization

02 History of Globalization

SYSTEMS

03 The Global Economy

04 Global Governance

05 Demography & Mobility

CULTURE & ISSUES

06 Global Culture & Media

07 Environment & Sustainability

08 Inequality, Citizenship & PH

Main UN Bodies

Body	Function
General Assembly	All 193 member states, one vote each — the main deliberative body, votes on resolutions (mostly non-binding recommendations)
Security Council	15 members (5 permanent: US, UK, France, Russia, China + 10 rotating). Only body that can authorize binding, enforceable action, including military intervention. The 5 permanent members hold VETO power — any one can block a resolution regardless of how the other 14 vote.
Secretariat	Administrative arm, headed by the Secretary-General, carries out the day-to-day work and programs of the UN
	Settles legal disputes

The Contemporary World

Complete Study Guide · AY 2026-2027

INTRODUCTION

00 Course Overview

FOUNDATIONS

01 Understanding Globalization

02 History of Globalization

SYSTEMS

03 The Global Economy

04 Global Governance

05 Demography & Mobility

CULTURE & ISSUES

06 Global Culture & Media

07 Environment & Sustainability

08 Inequality, Citizenship & PH

Body

Function

International
Court of
Justice (ICJ)

BETWEEN states
(not individuals),
based in The
Hague,
Netherlands

ECOSOC

Economic and
Social Council —
coordinates UN
economic, social,
and related
agency work
(WHO, UNESCO,
UNICEF report
here)

The Veto Power Problem
— Frequently Tested

The Security Council veto means the UN's most powerful enforcement body can be paralyzed whenever a conflict involves the interests of any ONE of the 5 permanent members. This structural flaw is a standard essay topic: "Is the UN Security Council structure still fit for purpose in today's world?" — there is no single correct answer, but you should be able to explain BOTH the original post-WWII logic for the veto and its modern criticisms.

The Contemporary World

Complete Study Guide · AY 2026-2027

INTRODUCTION

00 Course Overview

FOUNDATIONS

01 Understanding Globalization

02 History of Globalization

SYSTEMS

03 The Global Economy

04 Global Governance

05 Demography & Mobility

CULTURE & ISSUES

06 Global Culture & Media

07 Environment & Sustainability

08 Inequality, Citizenship & PH

State Sovereignty vs Global Governance — The Central Tension

Sovereignty is a state's supreme authority over its own territory and internal affairs, free from outside interference — a principle enshrined in the UN Charter itself. Yet solving genuinely global problems (pandemics, climate change, financial crises, terrorism) often requires countries to accept SOME external rules or coordination. This creates constant friction: how much sovereignty should a country give up for the sake of collective global problem-solving?

The Contemporary World

Complete Study Guide · AY 2026-2027

INTRODUCTION

00 Course Overview

FOUNDATIONS

01 Understanding Globalization

02 History of Globalization

SYSTEMS

03 The Global Economy

04 Global Governance

05 Demography & Mobility

CULTURE & ISSUES

06 Global Culture & Media

07 Environment & Sustainability

08 Inequality, Citizenship & PH

Current, Highly Citable 2026 Example

In January 2026, the United States formally withdrew from more than 60 international organizations and declared open opposition to the UN's Sustainable Development Goals and the 2030 Agenda. In 2025, the US voted with the international majority on only about 5% of UN General Assembly resolutions where a vote was recorded — a dramatic outlier. This is a live, real-time demonstration of the sovereignty-vs-global-governance tension: a powerful state choosing to prioritize its own sovereignty and interests over collective multilateral commitments, regardless of how the rest of the world votes.

Other Major International Organizations

Organization	Focus
WHO — World Health Organization	Global public health coordination, disease outbreak response (e.g.

The Contemporary World

Complete Study Guide · AY 2026-2027

INTRODUCTION

00 Course Overview

FOUNDATIONS

01 Understanding Globalization

02 History of Globalization

SYSTEMS

03 The Global Economy

04 Global Governance

05 Demography & Mobility

CULTURE & ISSUES

06 Global Culture & Media

07 Environment & Sustainability

08 Inequality, Citizenship & PH

Organization

Focus

COVID-19
pandemic
coordination)

UNESCO

Education,
science, and
cultural
cooperation;
maintains the
World Heritage
Site list

UNICEF

Children's
welfare,
education, and
protection
worldwide

NATO

Military alliance
(mostly North
America +
Europe),
collective
defense pact

ASEAN

Southeast Asian
regional political
and economic
cooperation
(covered in Ch.
03)

International Law —
How Does It Actually
Get Enforced?

Unlike domestic law,
international law has no single
police force or automatic

The Contemporary World

Complete Study Guide · AY 2026–2027

INTRODUCTION

00 Course Overview

FOUNDATIONS

01 Understanding Globalization

02 History of Globalization

SYSTEMS

03 The Global Economy

04 Global Governance

05 Demography & Mobility

CULTURE & ISSUES

06 Global Culture & Media

07 Environment & Sustainability

08 Inequality, Citizenship & PH

enforcement mechanism. It relies primarily on: (1) states voluntarily complying to maintain their reputation and relationships, (2) economic sanctions imposed by other states as a consequence for violations, (3) the ICJ and International Criminal Court (ICC) issuing rulings — though these bodies still depend on state cooperation to actually enforce judgments, since neither has its own police force.

Forward Link — Chapter 08

The sovereignty-vs-governance tension explored here becomes the foundation for Chapter 08's discussion of global citizenship: if state sovereignty limits what global institutions can actually enforce, what responsibility do INDIVIDUALS have in addressing problems states won't fully cooperate on?

INTRODUCTION

00 Course Overview

FOUNDATIONS

01 Understanding Globalization

02 History of Globalization

SYSTEMS

03 The Global Economy

04 Global Governance

05 Demography & Mobility

CULTURE & ISSUES

06 Global Culture & Media

07 Environment & Sustainability

08 Inequality, Citizenship & PH

Global Demography & Mobility

People move — for work, safety, education, and family. This chapter covers global migration patterns, urbanization, and gives special attention to the Philippines' unique, massive role in global labor migration, since this is very likely to appear as a case-study essay question.

Current Global Population Snapshot

8.3B

Current world population (2026)

1.5B

India — most populous country

1.4B

China — 2nd most populous, now declining

31.1

Global median age (years)

The UN projects global population will peak around **10.3 billion in**

The Contemporary World

Complete Study Guide · AY 2026-2027

INTRODUCTION

00 Course Overview

FOUNDATIONS

01 Understanding Globalization

02 History of Globalization

SYSTEMS

03 The Global Economy

04 Global Governance

05 Demography & Mobility

CULTURE & ISSUES

06 Global Culture & Media

07 Environment & Sustainability

08 Inequality, Citizenship & PH

the mid-2080s before gradually declining — driven mainly by falling fertility rates worldwide, now averaging 2.3 births per woman globally (down from far higher rates a generation ago).

Types of Human Migration

Type	Definition	Example
Labor migration	Moving primarily to work	OFWs, guest worker programs
Forced migration / refugees	Fleeing conflict, persecution, or disaster	Refugees from war zones, climate disasters
Internal migration	Moving within one's own country	Rural-to-urban migration to Metro Manila
Circular / temporary migration	Moving abroad for a fixed period, then returning	OFW contract workers on 2-year deployments
Permanent migration / diaspora settlement	Relocating and settling long-term or permanently abroad	Filipino-American, Filipino-Canadian communities

The Contemporary World

Complete Study Guide · AY 2026-2027

INTRODUCTION

00 Course Overview

FOUNDATIONS

01 Understanding Globalization

02 History of Globalization

SYSTEMS

03 The Global Economy

04 Global Governance

05 Demography & Mobility

CULTURE & ISSUES

06 Global Culture & Media

07 Environment & Sustainability

08 Inequality, Citizenship & PH

The Philippines: A
Global Labor
Migration Case Study

2.19M

Overseas Filipino Workers, 2024 (PSA)

\$35.6B

Total cash remittances, 2025 — an all-time record

7.3%

Share of Philippine GDP from remittances alone

57%

Share of OFWs who are women

Where OFW Remittances
Come From (2025)

Source Country	Share of Total Remittances
United States	39.7%
Singapore	7.3%
Saudi Arabia	6.6%
Japan	5.0%
United Kingdom	4.6%
	4.6%

The Contemporary World

Complete Study Guide · AY 2026-2027

INTRODUCTION

00 Course Overview

FOUNDATIONS

01 Understanding Globalization

02 History of Globalization

SYSTEMS

03 The Global Economy

04 Global Governance

05 Demography & Mobility

CULTURE & ISSUES

06 Global Culture & Media

07 Environment & Sustainability

08 Inequality, Citizenship & PH

Source
Country

Share of Total
Remittances

United Arab
Emirates

The Philippines is consistently the **world's 4th-largest remittance recipient**, after India, Mexico, and China — and the world's largest single source of seafarers and among the top sources of nurses globally. This isn't incidental: it reflects decades of deliberate Philippine government labor export policy (dating to the 1970s) alongside genuine global demand for Filipino healthcare, maritime, and domestic workers.

The Contemporary World

Complete Study Guide · AY 2026-2027

INTRODUCTION

00 Course Overview

FOUNDATIONS

01 Understanding Globalization

02 History of Globalization

SYSTEMS

03 The Global Economy

04 Global Governance

05 Demography & Mobility

CULTURE & ISSUES

06 Global Culture & Media

07 Environment & Sustainability

08 Inequality, Citizenship & PH

Current 2026
Development Worth
Knowing

A new 1% US tax on outbound cash remittances took effect in 2026, specifically affecting money OFWs in America send home. Economists tracked a surge in remittances in December 2025 as OFWs rushed to transfer funds before the tax began — a real, current illustration of how a single policy change in one country can immediately ripple into millions of Filipino households, and a strong example of protectionism (Ch. 03) intersecting directly with migration.

Why Migration
Matters — Weighing
Both Sides

Benefits of
Labor Migration

Remittances significantly boost household income and national GDP

Costs of
Labor
Migration

"Brain drain" — countries lose skilled workers (nurses, engineers) they invested in educating

The Contemporary World

Complete Study Guide · AY 2026-2027

INTRODUCTION

00 Course Overview

FOUNDATIONS

01 Understanding Globalization

02 History of Globalization

SYSTEMS

03 The Global Economy

04 Global Governance

05 Demography & Mobility

CULTURE & ISSUES

06 Global Culture & Media

07 Environment & Sustainability

08 Inequality, Citizenship & PH

Benefits of Labor Migration

Workers gain skills, savings, and international experience

Relieves domestic unemployment pressure

Builds diaspora networks that support trade, tourism, and cultural exchange

Costs of Labor Migration

Family separation — millions of Filipino children grow up with one or both parents working abroad

Vulnerability to exploitation, unsafe working conditions, or unfair labor practices abroad

Economic dependency on remittances can discourage domestic job creation

Urbanization & Global Cities

More than half the world's population now lives in urban areas, a trend accelerating rapidly in developing countries.

Global cities — like New York,

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Complete Study Guide · AY 2026-2027

INTRODUCTION

00 Course Overview

FOUNDATIONS

01 Understanding Globalization

02 History of Globalization

SYSTEMS

03 The Global Economy

04 Global Governance

05 Demography & Mobility

CULTURE & ISSUES

06 Global Culture & Media

07 Environment & Sustainability

08 Inequality, Citizenship & PH

London, Tokyo, Singapore, and increasingly Manila — function as command centers for the global economy: hubs for finance, corporate headquarters, media, and international migration, disproportionately influential relative to their physical size.

Metro Manila as a Global City

Metro Manila (including Quezon City, where QCU sits) functions as the Philippines' primary global city node — hosting the BPO industry's headquarters, major international corporate offices, embassies, and serving as the departure/return point for the majority of the country's 2+ million OFWs.

CHAPTER 06

Global Culture & Media

Beyond money and governments, globalization moves IDEAS, VALUES, and CULTURAL PRODUCTS across borders at unprecedented speed —

The Contemporary World

Complete Study Guide · AY 2026-2027

INTRODUCTION

00 Course Overview

FOUNDATIONS

01 Understanding Globalization

02 History of Globalization

SYSTEMS

03 The Global Economy

04 Global Governance

05 Demography & Mobility

CULTURE & ISSUES

06 Global Culture & Media

07 Environment & Sustainability

08 Inequality, Citizenship & PH

reshaping how people everywhere eat, dress, communicate, and see themselves.

Cultural Globalization
— Two Competing Fears

Concept	Core Argument
Cultural Homogenization	Global media and consumer brands are erasing local cultural differences, producing an increasingly uniform global culture — critics call this "Americanization" or "Westernization" of global taste, values, and consumption habits.
Cultural Hybridization	Local cultures don't passively absorb global influences — they actively blend, remix, and reinterpret them, producing entirely new hybrid cultural

The Contemporary World

Complete Study Guide · AY 2026-2027

INTRODUCTION

00 Course Overview

FOUNDATIONS

01 Understanding Globalization

02 History of Globalization

SYSTEMS

03 The Global Economy

04 Global Governance

05 Demography & Mobility

CULTURE & ISSUES

06 Global Culture & Media

07 Environment & Sustainability

08 Inequality, Citizenship & PH

Concept

Core Argument

forms rather than
simple uniformity.

Glocalization

Coined by sociologist Roland Robertson (Ch. 01), **glocalization** describes how global products and ideas get actively ADAPTED to local contexts rather than simply imposed unchanged. This is the most widely cited concept for explaining what actually happens in cultural globalization, more so than pure homogenization.

Philippine Examples of Glocalization

McDonald's serving **McSpaghetti** and rice meals only in the Philippines. Jollibee — a genuinely Filipino brand — expanding internationally while keeping Filipino flavor profiles for diaspora communities abroad. K-pop and Spotify algorithms surfacing OPM (Original Pilipino Music) to global audiences. Each is neither purely "global" nor purely "local" — they're a deliberate blend.

The Contemporary World

Complete Study Guide · AY 2026-2027

INTRODUCTION

00 Course Overview

FOUNDATIONS

01 Understanding Globalization

02 History of Globalization

SYSTEMS

03 The Global Economy

04 Global Governance

05 Demography & Mobility

CULTURE & ISSUES

06 Global Culture & Media

07 Environment & Sustainability

08 Inequality, Citizenship & PH

Media Flows & Global Communication

Era	Dominant Media	Characteristic
Pre-1990s	Print, radio, broadcast TV	Largely one-directional (national broadcasters to national audiences), limited cross-border flow
1990s-2000s	Cable TV, early internet	24-hour global news networks (CNN), beginning of real-time cross-border information flow
2010s-present	Social media, streaming platforms	Instant, many-to-many global communication; ordinary individuals, not just broadcasters, now shape global cultural flows (viral trends, influencer culture)

The Contemporary World

Complete Study Guide · AY 2026-2027

INTRODUCTION

00 Course Overview

FOUNDATIONS

01 Understanding Globalization

02 History of Globalization

SYSTEMS

03 The Global Economy

04 Global Governance

05 Demography & Mobility

CULTURE & ISSUES

06 Global Culture & Media

07 Environment & Sustainability

08 Inequality, Citizenship & PH

Digital Culture & the Filipino Internet Presence

The Philippines is consistently ranked among the world's heaviest social media-using populations by time spent online. This creates a genuinely two-way cultural flow: Filipino content, memes, and trends increasingly influence global online culture, not just the reverse — a meaningful shift from earlier eras where cultural flow was overwhelmingly one-directional (developed world to developing world).

Language & Globalization

Trend	Detail
English as global lingua franca	Dominant language of international business, science, aviation, and the internet — a direct legacy of British and American global influence historically

The Contemporary World

Complete Study Guide · AY 2026-2027

INTRODUCTION

00 Course Overview

FOUNDATIONS

01 Understanding Globalization

02 History of Globalization

SYSTEMS

03 The Global Economy

04 Global Governance

05 Demography & Mobility

CULTURE & ISSUES

06 Global Culture & Media

07 Environment & Sustainability

08 Inequality, Citizenship & PH

Trend

Detail

Language
endangerment

UNESCO estimates a significant share of the world's roughly 7,000 languages are at risk of disappearing this century, partly due to globalization pressure favoring dominant languages

Digital code-
switching

Taglish (Tagalog-English mixing) itself is a everyday linguistic product of globalization — reflecting the Philippines' colonial history and ongoing global integration simultaneously

The Contemporary World

Complete Study Guide · AY 2026-2027

INTRODUCTION

00 Course Overview

FOUNDATIONS

01 Understanding Globalization

02 History of Globalization

SYSTEMS

03 The Global Economy

04 Global Governance

05 Demography & Mobility

CULTURE & ISSUES

06 Global Culture & Media

07 Environment & Sustainability

08 Inequality, Citizenship & PH

Common Reflection Essay Prompt

"Is globalization erasing Filipino culture, or strengthening it?" Strong answers avoid a simple yes/no — they apply globalization directly: Filipino culture is simultaneously ABSORBING global influences (K-pop, US media, global fast food) AND actively EXPORTING itself globally (OFW diaspora spreading Filipino food/language worldwide, OPM gaining international streaming traction). Both directions are happening at once.

CHAPTER 07

Global Environment & Sustainability

Climate change and environmental degradation are the clearest example of a truly borderless problem — no single country can solve them alone, regardless of how much

The Contemporary World

Complete Study Guide · AY 2026-2027

INTRODUCTION

00 Course Overview

FOUNDATIONS

01 Understanding Globalization

02 History of Globalization

SYSTEMS

03 The Global Economy

04 Global Governance

05 Demography & Mobility

CULTURE & ISSUES

06 Global Culture & Media

07 Environment & Sustainability

08 Inequality, Citizenship & PH

sovereignty it holds. This chapter covers the global framework built to address this, and its genuinely uneven current progress.

The Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs)

Adopted by all 193 UN member states in 2015 as the **2030**

Agenda for Sustainable Development — 17

interconnected goals covering poverty, health, education, equality, climate, and governance, meant to be achieved by 2030.

- 1 No Poverty
- 2 Zero Hunger
- 3 Good Health & Well-being
- 4 Quality Education
- 5 Gender Equality
- 6 Clean Water & Sanitation
- 7 Affordable Clean Energy
- 8 Decent Work & Growth

The Contemporary World

Complete Study Guide · AY 2026-2027

INTRODUCTION

00 Course Overview

FOUNDATIONS

01 Understanding Globalization

02 History of Globalization

SYSTEMS

03 The Global Economy

04 Global Governance

05 Demography & Mobility

CULTURE & ISSUES

06 Global Culture & Media

07 Environment & Sustainability

08 Inequality, Citizenship & PH

9 Industry, Innovation, Infrastructure

10 Reduced Inequalities

11 Sustainable Cities

12 Responsible Consumption

13 Climate Action

14 Life Below Water

15 Life on Land

16 Peace, Justice, Strong Institutions

17 Partnerships for the Goals

The Contemporary World

Complete Study Guide · AY 2026-2027

INTRODUCTION

00 Course Overview

FOUNDATIONS

01 Understanding Globalization

02 History of Globalization

SYSTEMS

03 The Global Economy

04 Global Governance

05 Demography & Mobility

CULTURE & ISSUES

06 Global Culture & Media

07 Environment & Sustainability

08 Inequality, Citizenship & PH

Current 2026 Status — Genuinely Off Track

As of the 2026 Sustainable Development Report, **none of the 17 SDGs are on track to be achieved by the 2030 deadline.**

Roughly 16% of specific targets are progressing well, while another 16% are actively worsening. SDG 11 (Sustainable Cities), 14 (Life Below Water), 15 (Life on Land), and 16 (Peace, Justice, Institutions) are flagged as particularly off-track globally. This is a genuinely current, citable statistic — far more accurate than assuming steady linear progress toward 2030.

Who's Leading, Who's Lagging

Finding	Detail
Top performers	Nordic countries dominate — Finland, Sweden, and Denmark rank highest globally on the 2026 SDG Index, with 19 of the top 20 countries being European

The Contemporary World

Complete Study Guide · AY 2026-2027

INTRODUCTION

00 Course Overview

FOUNDATIONS

01 Understanding Globalization

02 History of Globalization

SYSTEMS

03 The Global Economy

04 Global Governance

05 Demography & Mobility

CULTURE & ISSUES

06 Global Culture & Media

07 Environment & Sustainability

08 Inequality, Citizenship & PH

Finding

Detail

Fastest-improving region

East and South Asia have shown the strongest SDG progress of any region since 2015, with India and China posting major rank improvements

Biggest barrier cited

Limited financing — the annual investment gap for developing countries to meet SDG targets has grown to trillions of dollars short of what's needed

Climate Change as a Global Governance Problem

Climate change is the textbook example of a **collective action problem**: every country benefits from a stable climate, but any single country reducing emissions alone bears real economic costs while other countries "free-ride" on the benefit. This structural tension explains why international climate agreements are

The Contemporary World

Complete Study Guide · AY 2026-2027

INTRODUCTION

00 Course Overview

FOUNDATIONS

01 Understanding Globalization

02 History of Globalization

SYSTEMS

03 The Global Economy

04 Global Governance

05 Demography & Mobility

CULTURE & ISSUES

06 Global Culture & Media

07 Environment & Sustainability

08 Inequality, Citizenship & PH

notoriously difficult to negotiate and enforce.

Agreement	Year	Key Feature
Kyoto Protocol	1997	First binding emissions targets, but only for developed countries — the US never ratified it
Paris Agreement	2015	Nearly universal participation; each country sets its OWN voluntary emissions targets ("Nationally Determined Contributions") rather than binding external targets — a deliberate design compromise to secure broader participation, at the cost of weaker enforcement

The Contemporary World

Complete Study Guide · AY 2026-2027

INTRODUCTION

00 Course Overview

FOUNDATIONS

01 Understanding Globalization

02 History of Globalization

SYSTEMS

03 The Global Economy

04 Global Governance

05 Demography & Mobility

CULTURE & ISSUES

06 Global Culture & Media

07 Environment & Sustainability

08 Inequality, Citizenship & PH

The Philippines & Climate Vulnerability

The Philippines is consistently ranked among the world's most disaster-vulnerable countries — facing an average of 20+ tropical cyclones annually, alongside earthquakes, volcanic activity, and rising sea levels threatening its thousands of islands. This makes the Philippines a frequently cited example of **climate injustice**: the country contributes a very small share of global greenhouse gas emissions historically, yet bears disproportionately severe consequences from a problem largely caused by heavily industrialized nations.

The Contemporary World

Complete Study Guide · AY 2026-2027

INTRODUCTION

00 Course Overview

FOUNDATIONS

01 Understanding Globalization

02 History of Globalization

SYSTEMS

03 The Global Economy

04 Global Governance

05 Demography & Mobility

CULTURE & ISSUES

06 Global Culture & Media

07 Environment & Sustainability

08 Inequality, Citizenship & PH

Exam-Critical Concept — Climate Justice

"Climate justice" argues that developed nations, which industrialized earlier and emitted the most historical greenhouse gases, bear greater responsibility for funding climate adaptation and mitigation in vulnerable developing nations like the Philippines — a frequently debated principle in international climate negotiations and a strong topic for position papers in this course.

CHAPTER 08

Global Inequality, Citizenship & the Philippines in Context

This closing chapter ties every previous chapter together: does globalization reduce inequality between and within countries, or worsen it? And once you

The Contemporary World

Complete Study Guide · AY 2026-2027

INTRODUCTION

00 Course Overview

FOUNDATIONS

01 Understanding Globalization

02 History of Globalization

SYSTEMS

03 The Global Economy

04 Global Governance

05 Demography & Mobility

CULTURE & ISSUES

06 Global Culture & Media

07 Environment & Sustainability

08 Inequality, Citizenship & PH

understand these global systems, what does it actually mean to act as a responsible "global citizen"? This is the chapter most likely to appear as a comprehensive final essay prompt.

Two Kinds of Global Inequality

Type	Definition	Trend
Inequality BETWEEN countries	Gaps in average wealth/ income comparing entire nations against each other	Has generally NARROWED in recent decades — largely due to rapid growth in China, India, and other emerging economies
Inequality WITHIN countries	Gaps between rich and poor citizens inside the same nation	Has WIDENED in many countries, including highly globalized economies, where gains from trade and technology often concentrate among

The Contemporary World

Complete Study Guide · AY 2026-2027

INTRODUCTION

00 Course Overview

FOUNDATIONS

01 Understanding Globalization

02 History of Globalization

SYSTEMS

03 The Global Economy

04 Global Governance

05 Demography & Mobility

CULTURE & ISSUES

06 Global Culture & Media

07 Environment & Sustainability

08 Inequality, Citizenship & PH

Type	Definition	Trend
		already-wealthy groups

The Key Insight Professors Look For

A country can look more "globally equal" on average (between-country gap narrowing) while its OWN citizens experience worsening inequality (within-country gap widening) at the same time. Both things are simultaneously true — this apparent contradiction is a favorite exam and discussion topic precisely because it resists a simple answer.

Conflict & Globalization

Globalization doesn't eliminate conflict — it changes its shape. Modern conflicts increasingly involve: cyberattacks crossing borders instantly, economic sanctions as a substitute for military action, competition over globally-traded resources, and non-state actors (terrorist networks, criminal organizations) that exploit the same global

The Contemporary World

Complete Study Guide · AY 2026-2027

INTRODUCTION

00 Course Overview

FOUNDATIONS

01 Understanding Globalization

02 History of Globalization

SYSTEMS

03 The Global Economy

04 Global Governance

05 Demography & Mobility

CULTURE & ISSUES

06 Global Culture & Media

07 Environment & Sustainability

08 Inequality, Citizenship & PH

mobility and communication tools that enable legitimate trade and travel.

Global Citizenship

Global citizenship is the idea that, beyond national identity, individuals hold responsibilities toward the wider world — human rights, environmental stewardship, and solidarity with people in other countries — even without any formal global government to enforce these obligations.

Dimension	What It Looks Like in Practice
Awareness	Understanding how local choices connect to global systems (e.g. consumer choices affecting global supply chains)
Responsibility	Recognizing ethical obligations that extend beyond one's own national borders
Participation	Engaging with global issues through

The Contemporary World

Complete Study Guide · AY 2026-2027

INTRODUCTION

00 Course Overview

FOUNDATIONS

01 Understanding Globalization

02 History of Globalization

SYSTEMS

03 The Global Economy

04 Global Governance

05 Demography & Mobility

CULTURE & ISSUES

06 Global Culture & Media

07 Environment & Sustainability

08 Inequality, Citizenship & PH

Dimension

What It Looks
Like in Practice

advocacy,
informed voting,
or direct civic
action

Synthesis — The
Philippines Across
Every Chapter

Pull the threads together: the Philippines is deeply enmeshed in EVERY dimension of globalization covered in this guide — economically through BPO and 2+ million OFWs (Ch. 03, 05), politically as an ASEAN member navigating great-power tensions (Ch. 03, 04), culturally through both absorbing and exporting media (Ch. 06), environmentally as one of the world's most climate-vulnerable nations despite minimal historical emissions (Ch. 07), and demographically as one of the largest sources of global labor migration on Earth (Ch. 05).

Chapter

Philippine
Connection

01 —
Globalization
Theory

OFW example
touches all five

The Contemporary World

Complete Study Guide · AY 2026-2027

INTRODUCTION

00 Course Overview

FOUNDATIONS

01 Understanding Globalization

02 History of Globalization

SYSTEMS

03 The Global Economy

04 Global Governance

05 Demography & Mobility

CULTURE & ISSUES

06 Global Culture & Media

07 Environment & Sustainability

08 Inequality, Citizenship & PH

Chapter**Philippine
Connection**dimensions
simultaneously**02 — History**Spanish
colonization
(1521) as an
early
globalization
wave; also
connects directly
to your RIZAL
course**03 — Global
Economy**BPO industry,
ASEAN
membership,
vulnerability to
US tariff/
remittance-tax
policy**04 — Global
Governance**UN member
state; navigates
sovereignty
tensions amid
great-power
competition in
the region**05 —
Demography**World's 4th-
largest
remittance
recipient;
massive labor
migration
economy**06 — Culture**Jollibee,
McSpaghetti,
OPM — textbook

The Contemporary World

Complete Study Guide · AY 2026–2027

INTRODUCTION

00 Course Overview

FOUNDATIONS

01 Understanding Globalization

02 History of Globalization

SYSTEMS

03 The Global Economy

04 Global Governance

05 Demography & Mobility

CULTURE & ISSUES

06 Global Culture & Media

07 Environment & Sustainability

08 Inequality, Citizenship & PH

Chapter**Philippine
Connection**glocalization
case studies07 —
EnvironmentAmong the
world's most
climate-disaster-
vulnerable
nations; central
climate justice
example**The Question This Whole
Course Builds Toward**

Nearly every final exam or capstone essay in this course asks some version of: *"Is globalization good or bad for the Philippines?"*

The strongest answers reject the binary.

Globalization has brought the Philippines real economic lifelines (remittances, BPO jobs) while also exposing it to real vulnerabilities (climate injustice, dependency on volatile foreign policy decisions like the 2026 remittance tax, brain drain).

A synthesis answer — weighing BOTH the benefits and the costs with specific, current evidence from this guide — will consistently outperform a one-sided answer.

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The Contemporary World

Complete Study Guide · AY 2026-2027

INTRODUCTION

00 Course Overview

FOUNDATIONS

01 Understanding Globalization

02 History of Globalization

SYSTEMS

03 The Global Economy

04 Global Governance

05 Demography & Mobility

CULTURE & ISSUES

06 Global Culture & Media

07 Environment & Sustainability

08 Inequality, Citizenship & PH

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Advance Prep Material · Current data

grounded as of mid-2026